

# Consent Form

Project title: Interactive Gantt Chart Builder

The primary aim of this project is to design, develop, and evaluate an interactive Gantt chart builder that will be integrated into the existing HWU honours project management system. This tool will provide structured guidance to help students create comprehensive project plans while offering supervisors visibility into student progress and planning quality.

Heriot-Watt University MACS department

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The purpose of this usability test is to evaluate the usability and effectiveness of the Interactive Gantt Chart Builder by observing how first-time users interact with the system. Participants will be asked to complete a series of tasks covering the core features of the tool, including creating and editing a Gantt chart, navigating the interface, and using the student view. The aim is to identify any aspects of the interface that are unclear, difficult to use, or behave unexpectedly, and to gather honest feedback that will inform the final evaluation of the system. The results will be used solely for the purposes of this dissertation project and will contribute to an assessment of whether the tool meets its usability requirements.

Participation Clause:

- Participation is entirely voluntary and consent can be withdrawn at any point during and after the study without penalty or obligation to provide a reason. To withdraw after the study has concluded, participants will need to provide the unique ID given to them.
- Participants are encouraged to answer all questions in the feedback questionnaire, though individual questions may be left blank if preferred.- Any questions a participant has regarding the study will be answered by the Principal Investigator before, during, or after the session.

1. I confirm that the purpose of this study was explained to me in sufficient detail and I have had the opportunity to consider the information, to ask questions and have these answered satisfactorily \*

☐ Agree

☐ Disagree

2. I confirm that I am over 18 years old. \*

☐ Agree

☐ Disagree

3. I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I am free to withdraw at any time, without giving any reason, and without consequences. \*

☐ Agree

☐ Disagree

4. I understand that any data I give will be used in the dissemination of finding sand will remain anonymous and that my signed consent form will be securely stored in the HWU One-Drive folder, which is password protected and can be accessed only by the MACS Director of Ethics and HWU Data Protection Officer. \*

☐ Agree

5. I feel I am well enough, physically and mentally, to complete the tasks as described in the Information Sheet. \*

☐ Agree

☐ Disagree

6. I agree to take part in the above study. \*

☐ Agree

☐ Disagree

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